Where does your work land? - complete text version

You've just started as a Sales Associate at Jin Cloud Solutions, a business-to-business, or B2B, technology provider specialising in cloud-based solutions that help businesses grow. As part of your onboarding, your manager is walking you through how your day-to-day tasks connect to the company's broader business goals. In a B2B environment, even minor tasks can have a substantial impact on sales outcomes. From researching potential leads to maintaining accurate customer relationship management, or CRM, records, each action supports senior team members, accelerates pipeline progression, and improves client engagement. Open each of your four tasks. Choose the business goal that the task best supports, thinking about how it enhances both team performance and the customer experience. For three of the tasks, then consider how the work contributes to the broader customer journey. If a choice is not right, the feedback explains why and you can try again. The company is fictional. This activity is not scored, and nothing you choose is stored or sent anywhere. Allow about 15 minutes.

How to use this version

You can do this activity on paper or in a document. For each task, write down the business goal you think it best supports, then read the feedback for every option. For three of the tasks, also choose how the work contributes to the broader customer journey and compare with the feedback.

The four business goals

- Lead qualification
- Pipeline progression
- Relationship building
- Effective sales conversations

Task 1 of 4: Prospect research

You've been asked to spend part of your morning using LinkedIn and industry databases to identify companies that could benefit from Jin Cloud Solutions' cloud platforms. You collect information such as company size, industry focus, and the contact details of decision-makers.

A. Which business goal does this task, prospect research, relate to?

- Lead qualification - Best fit. Feedback: That’s correct. Prospect research ensures that the sales team focuses on high-potential leads that align with Jin Cloud Solutions’ customer profile.
- Pipeline progression - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Prospect research is conducted before opportunities enter the sales pipeline.
- Relationship building - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Relationships develop after the initial engagement, not during the research stage.
- Effective sales conversations - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Research supports conversations indirectly, but its primary purpose is to qualify leads.

B. The broader customer journey

When you conduct prospect research, how does this task contribute to the broader customer journey?

- It ensures Jin Cloud Solutions focuses on the right leads from the start - Best fit. Feedback: That’s correct. Prospect research ensures the sales team invests time in the right opportunities, setting the foundation for a smoother journey.
- It directly builds long-term client relationships - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Relationships typically develop over time, following initial contact.
- It immediately closes new deals - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Research prepares the ground but doesn’t close deals.
- It provides post-sale support to customers - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Post-sale support happens after a deal is won.

Task 2 of 4: Updating the CRM

After joining a discovery call with a senior sales rep, you enter key details into the CRM: the client’s current challenges, their timeline for change, and their interest in Jin Cloud Solutions’ services.

A. Which business goal does this task, updating the CRM, relate to?

- Lead qualification - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. By this stage, the lead is already identified and qualified.
- Pipeline progression - Best fit. Feedback: That’s correct. Updating CRM records helps track opportunities and move them smoothly through the pipeline.
- Relationship building - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. CRM updates support internal coordination, not client relationships.
- Effective sales conversations - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Good records help later conversations, but the primary purpose of updating the CRM is to track and advance deals.

B. The broader customer journey

Updating CRM records after a sales call primarily supports the broader customer journey by:

- Helping the team track progress and maintain continuity - Best fit. Feedback: That’s correct. Accurate CRM updates ensure continuity, maintaining a consistent customer experience across all touchpoints.
- Instantly converting leads into customers - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Conversion depends on multiple later steps, not just record-keeping.
- Creating brand awareness in the marketplace - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Brand awareness is influenced by marketing, not CRM updates.
- Strengthening personal friendships with prospects - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. CRM records are about process efficiency, not personal friendships.

Task 3 of 4: Preparing a meeting brief

Your manager is meeting with the Chief Information Officer of a potential client. You gather information about the company’s recent technology investments, competitor tools they use, and recent press releases to prepare a summary document.

A. Which business goal does this task, preparing meeting briefs, relate to?

- Lead qualification - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Lead qualification happens earlier in the process.
- Pipeline progression - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Meeting preparation ensures quality discussions, not directly moving stages.
- Relationship building - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Relationship building comes during and after the conversation.
- Effective sales conversations - Best fit. Feedback: That’s correct. Preparing briefs equips reps to tailor their approach and deliver relevant discussions.

Task 4 of 4: Following up after a demo

After a product demo, you send follow-up emails to thank participants, include a summary of what was covered, and propose dates for the following conversation.

A. Which business goal does this task, scheduling follow-ups, relate to?

- Lead qualification - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. By this stage, the lead has already been identified.

- Pipeline progression - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Follow-ups nurture relationships rather than move the deal through pipeline stages.
- Relationship building - Best fit. Feedback: That’s correct. Follow-ups show attentiveness and professionalism, strengthening client trust.
- Effective sales conversations - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. The follow-up supports future discussions but isn’t the conversation itself.

B. The broader customer journey

Following up with a prospect after a demo contributes to the broader customer journey by:

- Building trust and keeping momentum in the sales process - Best fit. Feedback: That’s correct. A timely follow-up shows professionalism, builds trust, and keeps the prospect engaged on their journey.
- Immediately qualifying a new lead - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Qualification happens earlier in the process.
- Finalising the contract on the spot - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. A follow-up nurtures interest but doesn’t close contracts instantly.
- Providing technical support after implementation - Not the best fit. Feedback: Not quite. Technical support happens much later in the customer journey.

Your week at Jin Cloud Solutions

Here is where each of your tasks lands. Every one of them connects to a business goal and to the customer’s journey.

- Prospect research: Lead qualification
- Updating the CRM: Pipeline progression
- Preparing a meeting brief: Effective sales conversations
- Following up after a demo: Relationship building

By completing this activity, you’ve explored how everyday tasks in an entry-level sales role connect directly to larger business goals. Recognising these connections helps you see the value your contributions bring to the sales process, the team’s success, and the overall customer experience. As you grow in your role, remember that each small action not only builds your skills but also drives meaningful outcomes for the business and its clients.